Benzene (Asia-Pacific)

By Angeline Soh, Jenny Yi & Su Jie

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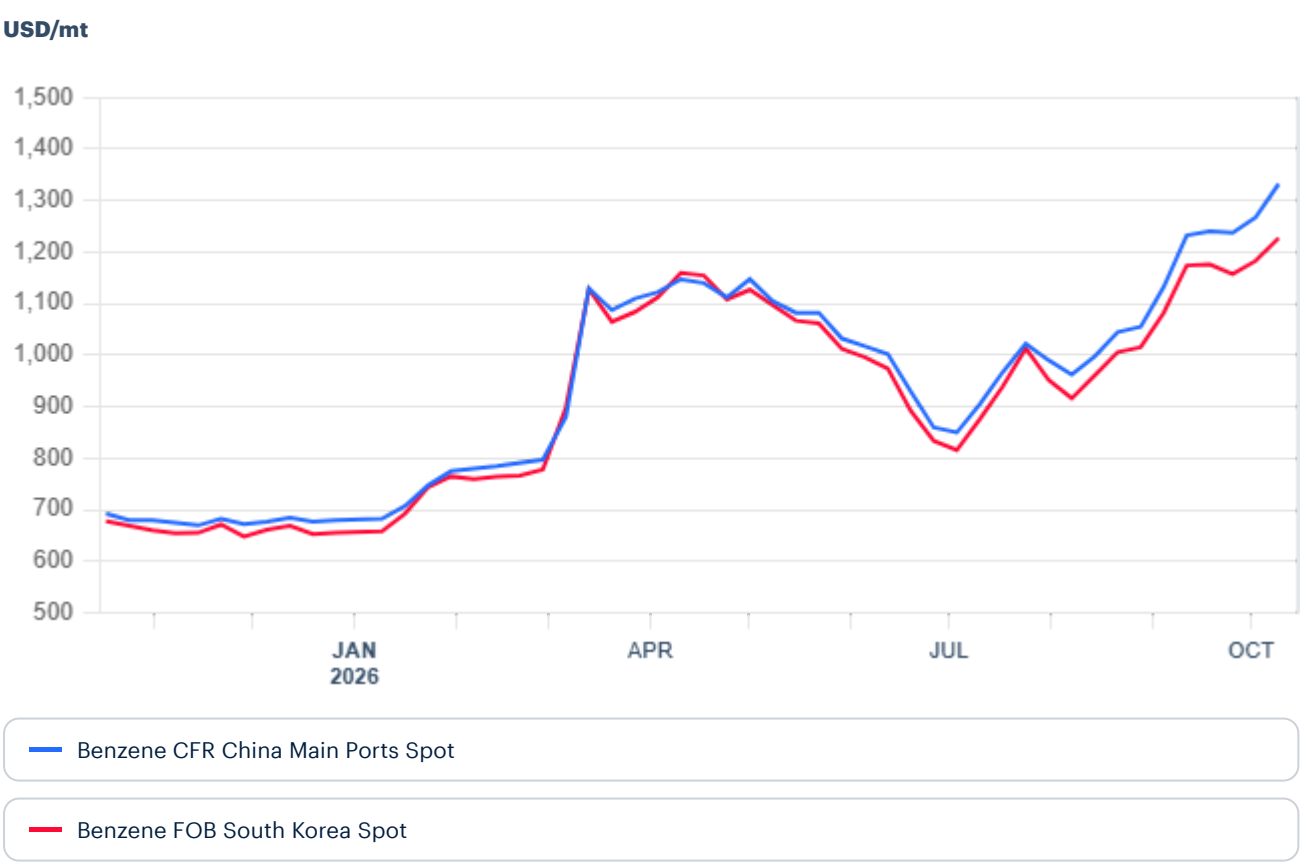
Market overview

AS OF 9 OCT 2026

Highlights

- FOB South Korea, CFR China weekly prices reach more than four-year high
- Post-holiday restocking coincides with crude price surges
- Concerns grow over benzene availability as feedstock toluene flows outside Asia for blending

Benzene



Market commentary

Asia benzene prices on an FOB South Korea and CFR China weekly basis climbed to their highest levels in more than four years, extending the rally as stronger crude oil prices lifted feedstock costs across the aromatics complex.

The market gained further momentum after China's weeklong National Day holiday came to an end, with downstream buyers returning to replenish inventories amid higher replacement costs and firmer seller price expectations.

The combination of post-holiday restocking demand and surging crude oil prices provided a fresh impetus to benzene values, with gains also filtering through to downstream derivatives. Sellers sought to reflect the higher upstream costs in their offers, while buyers faced increasing pressure to secure prompt cargoes before prices advanced further.

However, the extent of the price increases also raised concerns over the affordability of raw materials for downstream producers, particularly as margins continued to struggle to keep pace with the rally.

China remained the primary destination for regional benzene supplies, accounting for all South Korean benzene exports in August and September. The concentration of export flows towards China underscored the country's influence on regional price formation,

with Chinese buying interest and import requirements playing a key role in supporting prices.

Offers for November shipments had jumped by $15/tonne premium to FOB South Korea values right after the holiday. Market participants continued to monitor the pace of post-holiday procurement to determine whether demand would be sufficient to sustain the latest gains beyond the initial restocking period.

At the same time, concerns over increasingly tight benzene availability added another layer of support to the market. The recent movement of upstream toluene towards the US for gasoline blending has raised questions over the availability of feedstock streams within Asia, potentially tightening the regional supply balance. As toluene can be diverted toward blending when gasoline economics are attractive, competing demand from the US market could limit the volume of material available to Asian petrochemical producers and reinforce expectations of higher replacement costs.

Despite the bullish supply and cost signals, buying interest remained measured as downstream margins struggled to absorb the rapid increase in raw material prices. Some buyers were reluctant to commit to large volumes at elevated levels, wary that further crude price fluctuations could undermine the sustainability of the rally.

As a result, the gap between firm seller expectations and cautious procurement highlighted the tension between supply-side support and demand-side affordability.

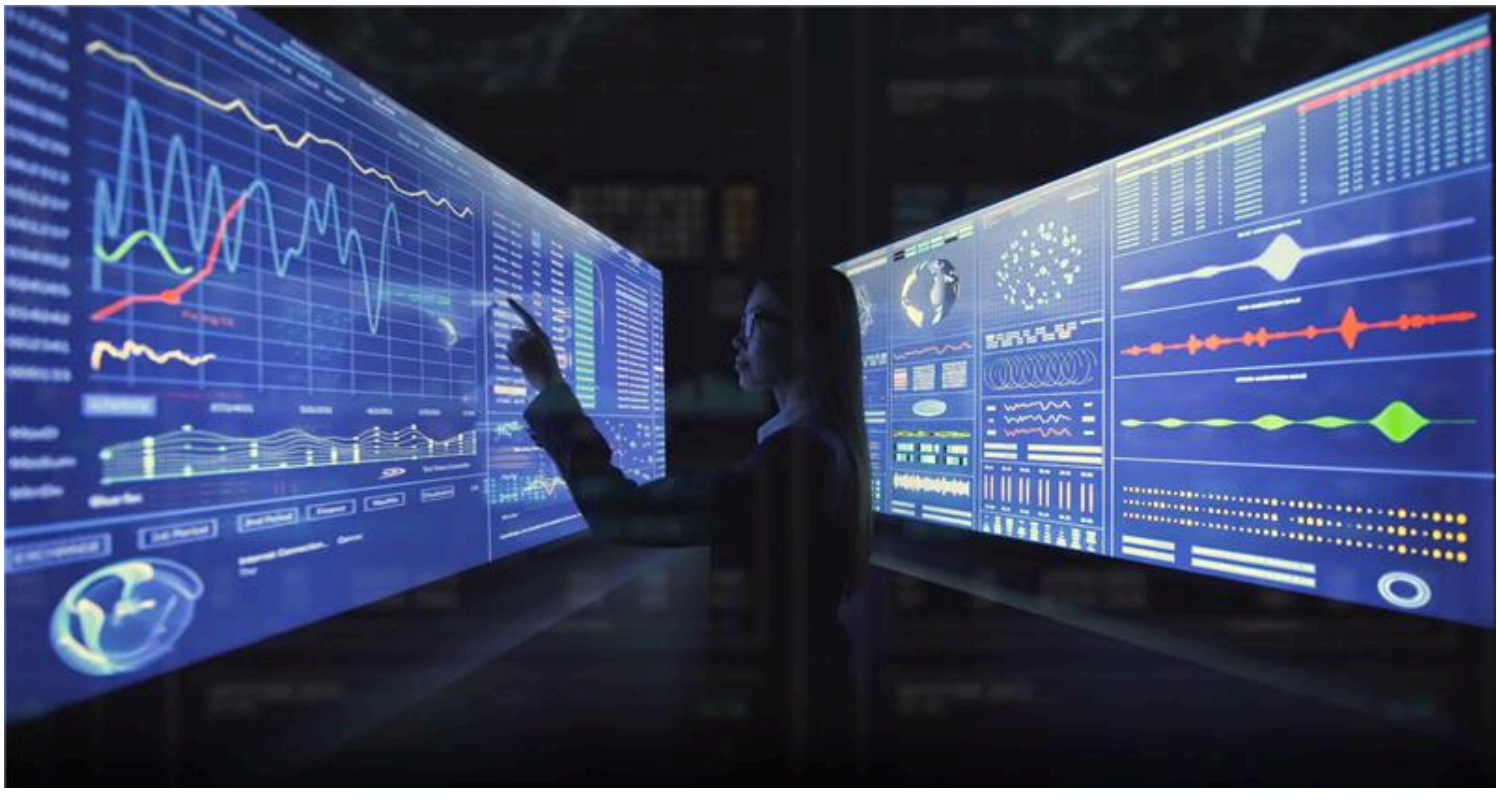
Outlook

- H2-Oct projections cautiously optimistic
- Several South Korean plants commence planned maintenance
- Widening buy-sell gap goes behind spot talks to pending term negotiations

Forecast

AS OF 6 MAY 2025

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Prices

AS OF 14 OCT 2026

Daily spot prices

Daily spot prices

Name	Unit	Low change	Low price	High price	High change	Mid price	Mid change	Frequency	Published
Benzene FOB South Korea Spot Day Close-Weighted Range	USD/mt	+12 (+0.94%)	1,286 ▲	1,287 ▲	+13 (+1.02%)	1,286.5 ▲	+12.5 (+0.98%)	Daily	14 Oct 2026
Benzene CFR Asia NE Premium/Discount Spot Day Close-Weighted Range	USD/mt	+15 (+1.12%)	1,355 ▲	1,375 ▲	+15 (+1.1%)	1,365 ▲	+15 (+1.11%)	Daily	14 Oct 2026
Benzene CFR Asia SE Premium/Discount Spot Day Close	USD/mt	+12 (+0.92%)	1,321 ▲	1,337 ▲	+13 (+0.98%)	1,329 ▲	+12.5 (+0.95%)	Daily	14 Oct 2026
Benzene CFR China Main Ports Spot	USD/mt	+15 (+1.12%)	1,355 ▲	1,375 ▲	+15 (+1.1%)	1,365 ▲	+15 (+1.11%)	Daily	14 Oct 2026
Benzene Ex-Tank China E Spot	CNY/mt	+250 (+2.36%)	10,850 ▲	11,050 ▲	+70 (+0.64%)	10,950 ▲	+160 (+1.48%)	Daily	14 Oct 2026

Weekly spot prices

Spot prices - price range at close of the week

Name	Unit	Low change	Low price	High price	High change	Mid price	Mid change	Frequency	Published
Benzene FOB South Korea Spot Week Close	USD/mt	+70 (+5.88%)	1,260 ▲	1,261 ▲	+71 (+5.97%)	1,260.5 ▲	+70.5 (+5.92%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026
Benzene FOB Asia SE Spot Week Close	USD/mt	+70 (+5.71%)	1,295 ▲	1,306 ▲	+71 (+5.75%)	1,300.5 ▲	+70.5 (+5.73%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026
Benzene CFR Asia NE Spot Week Close	USD/mt	+50 (+3.92%)	1,325 ▲	1,345 ▲	+50 (+3.86%)	1,335 ▲	+50 (+3.89%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026
Benzene CFR China Main Ports Spot Week Close-Weighted Range	USD/mt	+65 (+5.16%)	1,325 ▲	1,345 ▲	+65 (+5.08%)	1,335 ▲	+65 (+5.12%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026
Benzene CFR Asia SE Premium/Discount Spot Week Close-Weighted Range	USD/mt	+70 (+5.71%)	1,295 ▲	1,311 ▲	+71 (+5.73%)	1,303 ▲	+70.5 (+5.72%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026

Spot prices - price range for the week

Name	Unit	Low change	Low price	High price	High change	Mid price	Mid change	Frequency	Published
Benzene FOB South Korea Spot	USD/mt	+23 (+1.96%)	1,194 ▲	1,261 ▲	+66 (+5.52%)	1,227.5 ▲	+44.5 (+3.76%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026
Benzene FOB Asia SE Spot	USD/mt	+23 (+1.91%)	1,229 ▲	1,306 ▲	+66 (+5.32%)	1,267.5 ▲	+44.5 (+3.64%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026
Benzene CFR Asia NE Spot	USD/mt	+25 (+1.99%)	1,280 ▲	1,345 ▲	+50 (+3.86%)	1,312.5 ▲	+37.5 (+2.94%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026
Benzene CFR China Main Ports Spot	USD/mt	+65 (+5.18%)	1,320 ▲	1,345 ▲	+65 (+5.08%)	1,332.5 ▲	+65 (+5.13%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026
Benzene CFR Asia SE Premium/Discount Spot	USD/mt	+23 (+1.91%)	1,229 ▲	1,311 ▲	+66 (+5.3%)	1,270 ▲	+44.5 (+3.63%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026

Contract prices

Contract prices

Name	Period	Unit	Low change	Low price	High price	High change	Mid price	Mid change	Frequency	Published
Benzene CFR Asia Contract	Oct	USD/mt	+190 (+18.36%)	1,225 ▲	1,225 ▲	+190 (+18.36%)	1,225 ▲	+190 (+18.36%)	Monthly	30 Sep 2026

Pricing commentary

Daily spot prices

Today's FOB South Korea Final Assessment (KFA) price table ($/tonne):

Half month	Price range
H2 Oct '26	1,303-1,304
H1 Nov '26	**1,286-1,287**
H2 Nov '26	**1,286-1,287**
H1 Dec '26	1,248-1,248
H2 Dec '26	1,248-1,248
H1 Jan '27	1,248-1,248

Assessment period: third and fourth half-month forward

FOB South Korea - deals, bids and offers ($/tonne)

Shipment	Deals	Bids	Offers
H2 Nov	-	1,280-1,286	-
Dec	1,248	-	-

CFR China prices are assessed to be higher alongside FOB South Korea values.

CFR NE Asia prices are assessed to be at parity with CFR China values.

CFR SE Asia prices are assessed at a premium of $35-50/tonne to FOB South Korea quotes.

Weekly spot prices

DAILY CLOSINGS

Spot FOB Korea daily prices ($/tonne)		
Date	**Low end**	**High end**
5 October	**1,194**	1,195
6 October	1,199	1,200
7 October	1,203	1,204
8 October	1,260	1,261
9 October	1,260	**1,261**

CFR China Daily Prices ($/tonne)		
Date	**Low end**	**High end**
8 October	1,320	1,340
9 October	1,325	1,345

CFR SE Asia Daily Prices ($/tonne)		
Date	**Low end**	**High end**
5 October	1,229	1,245
6 October	1,234	1,250
7 October	1,238	1,254
8 October	1,295	1,311
9 October	1,295	1,311

Click here for latest benzene inventories, arrivals and consumption.

FULL RANGE FOR THE WEEK

Northeast Asia

FOB Korea - deals, bids and offers ($/tonne)				
Date	**Shipment**	**Deals**	**Bids**	**Offers**
5 October	Dec		1,147-1,150	
6 October	Nov	-	-	1,200-1,204
	Dec	-	1,150	1,175
7 October	Nov/Dec	-	-	-
8 October	Dec			1,229-1,235
9 October	Nov/Dec	-	-	-

China / Taiwan

Offers for China-bound November shipments were at a premium of $100/tonne to FOB South Korea against buying ideas in the low $80s-90/tonne premium to FOB South Korea.

Southeast Asia

The floating FOB SE Asia assessments were at a premium of $35-45/tonne to FOB South Korea.

The floating CFR SE Asia levels assessments were at a premium of $35-50/tonne to FOB South Korea.

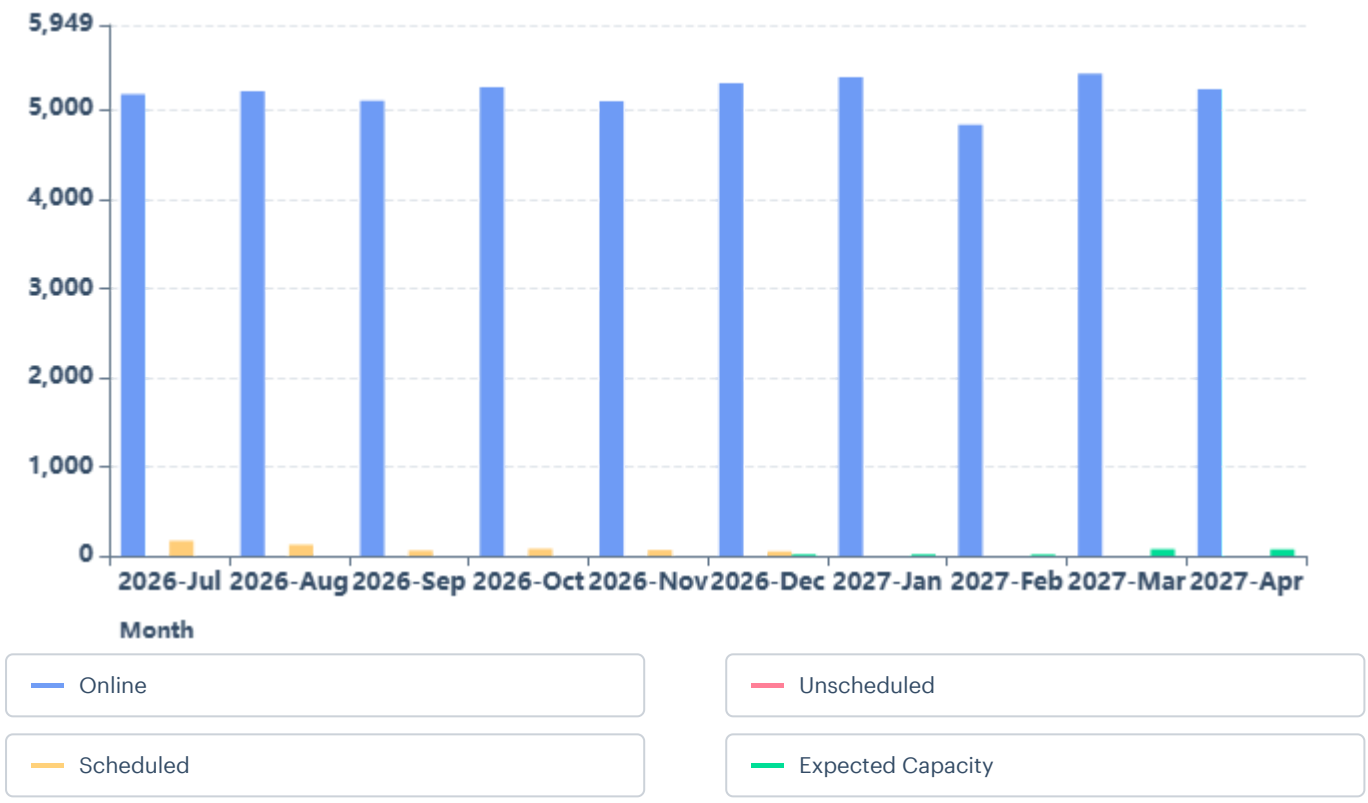
Supply and demand

AS OF 13 OCT 2026

Highlights

- Perceptions of supply availability to diverge across northeast and southeast Asia
- Derivative demand to stay curbed by poor margins, uncertain end-use production as US-Iran war rages on
- Eyes on uptrend sustainability on post-Golden Week restocking

Capacity and shutdowns



Unit: '000 tonnes

Shutdowns

Location	Company	Site	Start	End	Plant No.	Cause	Capacity loss	Total annual capacity (kt)	Last updated
China	Sinopec Yangzi PC	Nanjing	10 May 2026 (Market information)	31 Dec 2026 (Assumptions)	1	Scheduled	100% (est. 45.3 kt)	70	03 Aug 2026
China	Sinopec Yangzi PC	Nanjing	10 May 2026 (Market information)	31 Dec 2026 (Assumptions)	2	Scheduled	100% (est. 103.5 kt)	160	03 Aug 2026
China	Sinopec Yangzi PC	Nanjing	10 May 2026 (Market information)	31 Dec 2026 (Assumptions)	3	Scheduled	100% (est. 103.5 kt)	160	03 Aug 2026
China	Sinopec Yangzi PC	Nanjing	10 May 2026 (Market information)	31 Dec 2026 (Assumptions)	4	Scheduled	100% (est. 64.7 kt)	100	03 Aug 2026
China	Sinopec Yangzi PC	Nanjing	10 May 2026 (Market information)	31 Dec 2026 (Assumptions)	5	Scheduled	100% (est. 64.7 kt)	100	03 Aug 2026
China	Sinopec Anqing PC Co	Anqing	05 Sep 2026 (Market information)	04 Nov 2026 (Market information)	1	Scheduled	100% (est. 10.5 kt)	63	08 Sep 2026
China	Sinopec Anqing PC Co	Anqing	05 Sep 2026 (Market information)	04 Nov 2026 (Market information)	2	Scheduled	100% (est. 16.7 kt)	100	08 Sep 2026
Thailand	Rayong Olefins	Map Ta Phut	01 Oct 2026 (Market information)	30 Nov 2026 (Market information)	1	Scheduled	100% (est. 26.7 kt)	160	13 Feb 2026
Thailand	Rayong Olefins	Map Ta Phut	01 Oct 2026 (Market information)	30 Nov 2026 (Market information)	2	Scheduled	100% (est. 4.2 kt)	25	13 Feb 2026

Capacity changes

Location	Company	Site	Plant No.	Type	Estimated start	New annual capacity (kt)	Capacity change (kt)	% Change	Last updated
China	Sabic Gulei Petrochemicals	Gulei	1	New Plant	Nov 2026	200 ▲	200	100.00%	16 Sep 2025
South Korea	S-oil Corp.	Onsan	8	New Plant	Feb 2027	280 ▲	280	100.00%	07 Mar 2026
South Korea	Yncc	Yeosu	3	Permanent Closure	Apr 2027	0 ▼	-120	-100.00 %	12 Oct 2026
China	Sinopec Jiujiang Company	Jiujiang	5	New Plant	May 2027	200 ▲	200	100.00%	02 Nov 2025
China	Sinopec Jiujiang Company	Jiujiang	6	New Plant	May 2027	120 ▲	120	100.00%	02 Nov 2025
China	Huajin Aramco Petrochemical	Panjin	1	New Plant	May 2027	130 ▲	130	100.00%	13 Oct 2026
China	Huajin Aramco Petrochemical	Panjin	2	New Plant	May 2027	290 ▲	290	100.00%	13 Oct 2026
China	Huajin Aramco Petrochemical	Panjin	4	New Plant	May 2027	80 ▲	80	100.00%	13 Oct 2026
China	Sinopec Zhenhai Ref and Chem	Zhenhai	5	New Plant	May 2027	200 ▲	200	100.00%	31 Jan 2024
China	Huajin Aramco Petrochemical	Panjin	3	New Plant	Aug 2027	250 ▲	250	100.00%	13 Oct 2026

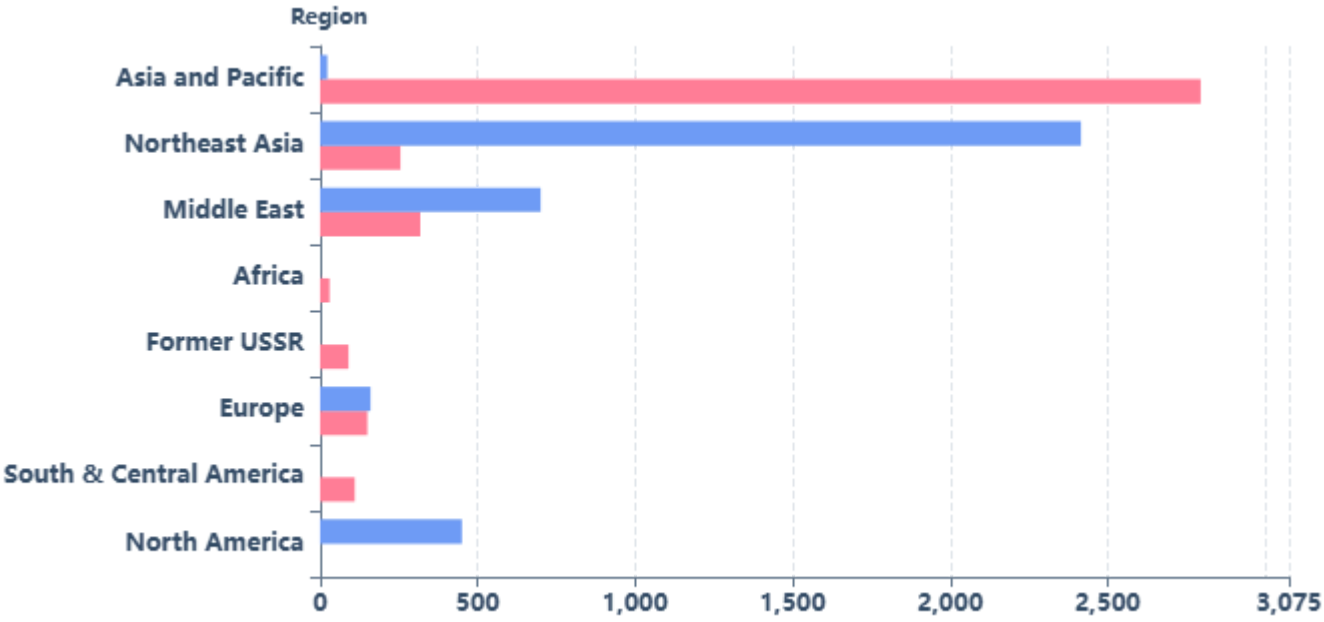
Value chain commentary

Click here for the Asia feedstocks and petrochemicals weekly summary.

Trade balance

AS OF 21 AUG 2026

2026 Forecast Regional Trade



Unit: '000 tonnes

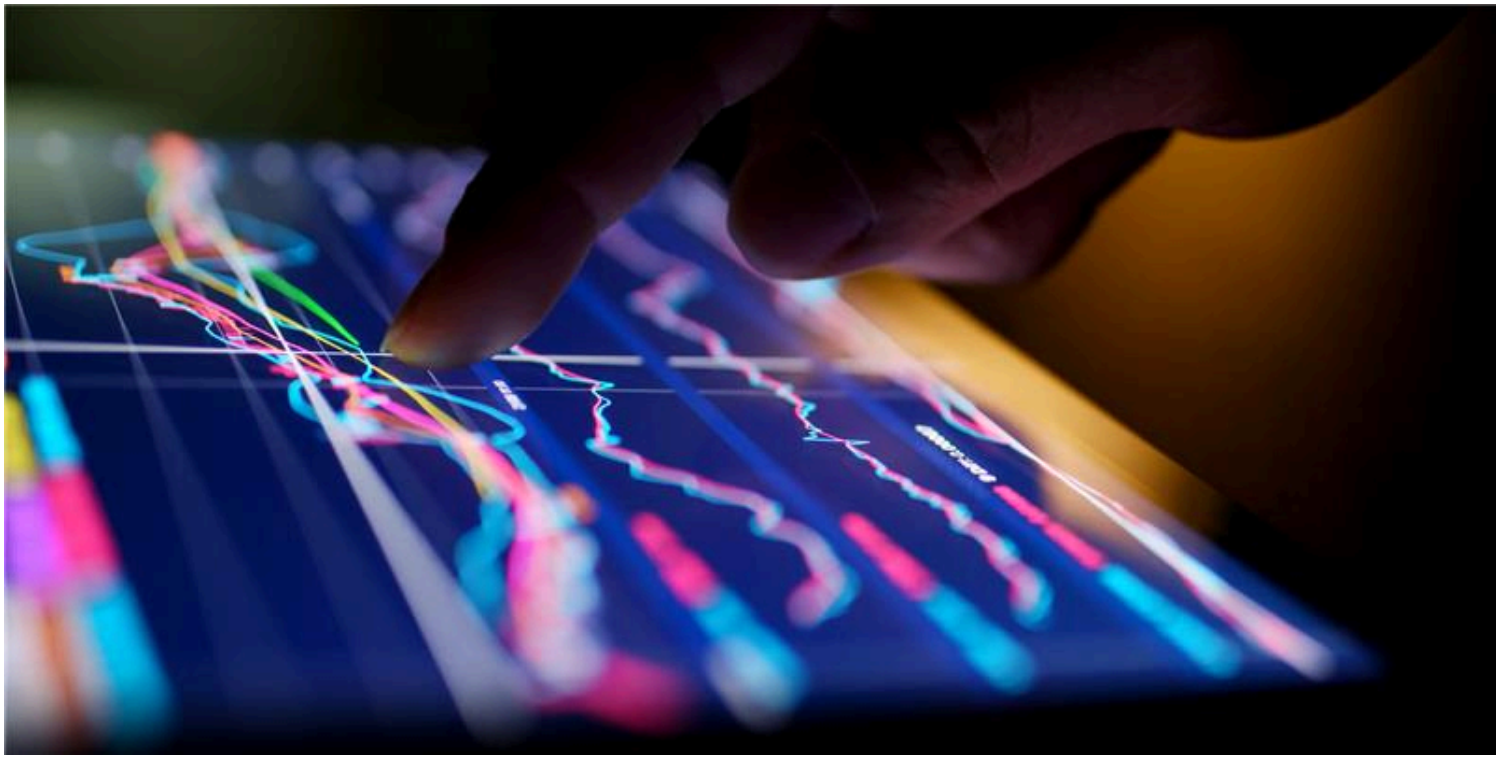
Imports

Exports

Margins

AS OF 6 MAY 2025

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